B.C., but it is generally agreed that it was not given its present shape until some 800 years later (about A.D. 454). It consists of 12 *angas* (sections), the last of which is subdivided into 14 *purvas* (former texts) and 5 *prakaranas*, along with other *sutra* (aphoristic) literature. Among later works, mention may be made of Lokaprakasha, an encyclopaedia of Jainism compiled by Vinaya-Vijai in A.D. 1652.

The Digambaras hold that the entire literature was destroyed about A.D. 789. Some of the books, however, were saved in Nepal and in Sravana Belgola (in Mysore), the Jain headquarters of south India (and the second most important place of Jain pilgrimage, where a colossal statue of Lord Gommateshvara exists). The language of their canonical literature was originally Ardha-Magadhi, a blend dialect of the province of Magadha (modern Bihar), but as the texts are largely rewritten it would be better to call it Apabhramsha or Jain-Prakrit, a corrupt form of Sanskrit. From at least the 9th century, Jain texts were also written in Kanarese.

PHILOSOPHY

Jain metaphysics is a dualistic system dividing the universe into two ultimate and independent categories: living beings or souls *(jivas)*, which permeate natural forces such as wind and fire as well as plants, animals and human beings; and non-living entities *(ajivas)*, which include space, time and matter.

The next most important concept is that of *karma*, a subtle invisible substance composed from one of the types of matter, which flows into and clogs the *jiva*, causing the bondage of life and transmigration. This inflow can be stopped by many lives of penance and disciplined conduct, resulting in the final *moksha*, or liberation, the ultimate goal of human endeavor. Karmic matter is elaborately classified according to its effect: for instance, one type is that which prevents true knowledge; another, that which causes pleasure or pain. Since no god has a place in Jainism, *karma* comes to occupy a very central position, for most of the functions of a god are appropriated by the soul and its potential power. Souls are divided into those that have attained perfection and those still in bondage. Of the former there are five classes in order of merit, the five Lords of Jainism.